

词汇: *breathwork* 呼吸法

- 1 Whether you've reached work or study **burnout**, you're going through relationship dramas, or you just feel **weighed down** by life in general, stress is something that's difficult to avoid. If only there were an easy and free way to **alleviate** it. Luckily, there is! Breathwork. Breathing is the first and last thing we do on this planet, and it's the simplest way we can alleviate stress and anxiety both immediately and long-term, when done properly. So, how can we **reap the benefits**?
- 2 It's about slowing down. "We all tend to **hyperventilate**, breathing too fast and not very effectively," says David Spiegel, professor of psychiatry and behavioural sciences at Stanford University in the US. One way to make our breathing more intentional is a technique called 'cyclic **sighing**', with a focus on **prolonged exhalation**. Begin with a deep **inhale** through your nose. Just when you think you're done, take a short, sharp breath to fully fill the lungs. Then, let out a slow and extended sigh to completely empty your lungs. A 2023 study published in PubMed by Spiegel and colleagues found that just five minutes a day of cyclic sighing improved mood and lowered anxiety.
- 3 For a more advanced method, try 'coherent breathing'. To do this, you want to find a comfortable position, with one hand on your belly, and the other on your chest. Inhale through your nose for about six seconds, making the hand on your belly rise by engaging your **diaphragm**. Then exhale for the same duration. The key is to keep your breath smooth and continuous. "Imagine your breath as a slow **tide** coming in and going out," says Guy Fincham, who leads a breathwork research lab at Brighton and Sussex Medical School in the UK. The A52 breath method is similar, except at the end of the exhalation, you **hold your breath** for a couple of seconds before breathing in again.
- 4 Slowing down our breathing works because it relaxes the **sympathetic nervous system**, which is responsible for the 'fight-or-flight' response and activates the **parasympathetic nervous system**, responsible for the body's 'rest-and-digest' functions. This calms the body. So, whenever you start to feel **overwhelmed**, remember that you have this easy and instant stress-reliever in your toolkit.

测验与练习

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 _____

Paragraph 2 _____

Paragraph 3 _____

Paragraph 4 _____

- a. A solution to a problem
- b. Filling and emptying your lungs
- c. Why it works
- d. Breathwork for pregnant women
- e. A wave-like breathing method
- f. The long-term benefits of breathwork

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. What does 'there is' refer to in the following sentence in paragraph 1? *But **there is!***
 - a. an easy and free way to alleviate stress
 - b. breathwork
 - c. stress
2. Why does the writer describe breathing as 'the first and last thing we do on this planet'?
 - a. to suggest people breathe incorrectly
 - b. to show that breathing is important but often ignored
 - c. to explain how the lungs work
3. For breathwork to be effective, it takes up a lot of time.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
4. The A52 breath method requires you to breathe while standing up.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given

5. How does slowing down our breathing make us feel less stressed, according to the article?
- It makes us pause what we're doing for a short period.
 - More oxygen in the body has a calming effect.
 - It calms the body's stress response and activates its rest functions.

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

We all know how to breath – we do it to survive. But how can we make sure we **1)** _____ of something that comes so naturally? We want to avoid **2)** _____ by pausing to take a deep breath in, followed by a **3)** _____ exhalation. So, next time you're suffering with **4)** _____, try breathwork to **5)** _____ the stress.

hyperventilating	alleviate	burnout
tide		prolonged
reap the benefits		diaphragm

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

burnout	精疲力竭，倦怠
weighed down	身负重压的，被压得喘不过气
alleviate	减轻，缓解
reap the benefits	收获益处
hyperventilate	过度换气，呼吸过速
sigh	叹气，叹息
prolonged	延长很久的，拉长的
exhalation	呼气，吐气
inhale	吸气，吸入
diaphragm	胸隔膜
tide	潮水
hold your breath	屏住气息
sympathetic nervous system	交感神经系统
parasympathetic nervous system	副交感神经系统
overwhelmed	不堪重负，不知所措

答案

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 **a) A solution to a problem**

Paragraph 2 **b) Filling and emptying your lungs**

Paragraph 3 **e) A wave-like breathing method**

Paragraph 4 **c) Why it works**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **a.** 'There is' refers to the previous sentence, *'If only **there were an easy and free way to alleviate it**'*.
2. **b.** Breathing is something we do for our entire lives and is important for survival, but the implication is that we do not harness its potential for stress relief.
3. **b. False.** *A 2023 study published in PubMed by Spiegel and colleagues found that **just five minutes a day** of cyclic sighing improved mood and lowered anxiety.*
4. **c. Not given.** It is not specified in which position the A52 breath method should be done.
5. **c.** *Slowing down our breathing works because it **relaxes** the sympathetic nervous system, which is responsible for **the 'fight-or-flight' response**, and **activates** the parasympathetic nervous system, responsible for the body's **'rest-and-digest' functions**.*

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

We all know how to breath – we do it to survive. But how can we make sure we **reap the benefits** of something that comes so naturally? We want to avoid **hyperventilating** by pausing to take a deep breath in, followed by a **prolonged** exhalation. So, next time you're suffering with **burnout**, try breathwork to **alleviate** the stress.